

THAW A CREATURE - v1.1 Production Baseline Revision Summary

This revision keeps the approved v1.0 survival/shared-Ice production baseline and adds **rideable Equipped creatures as launch scope**. Every creature can be mounted; when not ridden it keeps follower behavior. The player may Ride/Unride during exploration, and mounted combat is a presentation of the same universal survival attack rather than a new combat progression system.

Current production checkpoint

- Week 1 prototype validation: **PASS**.
- D7-R13 progression validation: **PASS**.
- Survival Pressure validation: **PASS**.
- The full approved survival package S01-S06 is promoted into launch scope.
- Day 8 persistence foundation: **COMPLETE**.
- Day 9 multiplayer + personal bases: **IN PROGRESS** under concurrent engineering.
- Existing Day-8/Day-9 work is not restarted merely because the canonical documents changed; new requirements are integrated at the smallest safe production boundary.

Canonical authority after Week 1

Week 1 is now a historical validation artifact rather than the production-behavior authority.

For launch production, use this order: 1. Concise GDD v0.7 - player-facing intent. 2. Launch Technical Implementation Specification v0.7 - production behavior and architecture. 3. Implementation Constants v1.1 - exact first-pass values, content tables, and AI guardrails. 4. Development Plan v1.1 - implementation order, ownership, and gates. 5. Bare-Minimum Prototype Technical Specification v1.0 FINAL - historical Week-1 behavior and validation evidence.

The Prototype Technical Specification remains authoritative for what Week 1 actually validated, but it must not override an explicitly promoted launch rule in the newer production documents.

Survival Pressure - promoted launch scope

The full validated package is now canonical:

- one universal survival tool with one simple swing verb;
- stationary Frost Sprites with readable telegraph -> attack -> cooldown behavior;
- Guarded Ice encounters across all five geographic Ice tiers;
- Frost Sprite hits reduce **CurrentWarmth**; there is no Player HP;
- region-scaled Frost Sprite Warmth damage;
- session-only Vitality for the currently Equipped creature;
- non-permanent Frosted/Downed state at zero creature Vitality;
- Frosted forces Unride, blocks Ride, removes mounted Speed, and never removes ownership;
- own-Hearth recovery restores creature Vitality and Speed;
- minimal survival feedback;
- breakable route obstacles using the same universal swing verb.

Survival exists to strengthen retrieval. It does **not** create a separate combat-progression game.

Still excluded without a separate later decision: - Player HP; - permanent creature death; - multiple weapons or weapon classes; - weapon rarity/durability/upgrades/inventory; - combos/block/heavy attacks/stamina; - enemy drops/currency/XP/levels; - bosses; - roaming/pathfinding/chase enemies; - autonomous pet combat AI or independent creature combat; - Wood/Stone/material currencies; - crafting/recipes/resource farming.

Mounted Equipped Creatures - approved launch scope

Every creature is mountable at launch. The creature selected through the existing Equip flow remains the single **EquippedCreatureGUID** and has two non-persistent exploration presentation states:

FOLLOWING <-> RIDING

Rules: - Equip/Unequip still occurs at the player's own base/Pen management flow. - Equipping from Pen clears that Pen slot and the Equipped copy earns no Pen income. - An Equipped creature starts/rejoins in **FOLLOWING**. - In **FOLLOWING**, the creature uses the existing lightweight follower behavior and the player moves on foot at base WalkSpeed 16. - **Ride** and **Unride** are available during exploration without returning to base, including while carrying Ice. - In **RIDING**, movement uses that exact copy's **FinalWalkSpeed**. - Ride/Unride never changes ownership, Pen allocation, income allocation, Ice ownership, or the Equipped GUID. - **IsRiding** / **MountState** is runtime-only and is not persisted. - Every production creature uses its authored **Seat** as the default rider anchor. Optional per-species presentation profiles may improve rider pose, camera, offsets, and animation without adding species-specific traversal powers. - Frosted/Downed immediately forces Unride, blocks Ride, and leaves the creature logically Equipped. Own-Hearth recovery restores Vitality and allows Riding again.

Universal survival attack while mounted

The player still learns **one survival attack input**.

FOLLOWING / on foot -> universal tool swing
RIDING -> Mounted Strike

Both use the same gameplay attack: - same configured damage/effect; - same cooldown; - same approved target categories (Frost Sprites and approved breakable route obstacles); - same server authority and validation; - no species, rarity, Scale, WeightMultiplier, or Speed damage scaling.

Mounted Strike originates from a server-authoritative ground/front combat origin associated with the mount rather than the rider's hand/Seat height. Effective attack range stays size-independent so a giant Nidhogg is not stronger than a Rabbit. There is no trample/contact damage. Species-specific bites, stomps, kicks, swipes, headbutts, etc. are presentation only. Giant-mount camera/target readability may use scale-aware camera offsets and/or a subtle valid-target marker.

This does **not** authorize autonomous pet combat AI, creature Damage stats, autonomous attacks, creature-specific combat abilities, or a mount-combat progression tree.

Regional Frost Sprite Warmth damage - approved

Region	Main Ice	Recommended Warmth	Frost Sprite Warmth Damage / Hit
Snowfield	Regular	100	10
Frozen Pass	Thick	1,000	100
Ancient Expanse	Ancient	10,000	1,000
Black Ice Hollow	Black	100,000	10,000
Meteor Reach	Meteor	1,000,000	100,000

First-pass rule:

FrostSpriteWarmthDamage = **RegionRecommendedWarmth** * 0.10

Use the authored/configured region value. Do not scale Sprite Warmth damage from the player's current **MaxWarmth**, Ice rarity, Ice size, hidden creature, or Special-Ice flag.

This makes old-region threats naturally become weaker as the player progresses.

Universal shared-Ice multiplayer contract - approved

Every spawned Ice opportunity is one authoritative server object shared by all players.

This applies to: - Regular; - Thick; - Ancient; - Black; - Meteor; - Special Ice; - onboarding/tutorial guidance. There are no private per-player Ice copies.

First valid server-side Grab wins.

On carrier failure before deposit - Freeze, character death, Reset Character/respawn, or disconnect - the **exact same Ice** returns to the shared world at the carrier's last valid world position:

same IceInstanceID
 same IceType
 same hidden CreatureID
 same Rarity
 same WeightMultiplier
 same Scale
 same Special metadata, if any
 -> OwnerUserID = nil
 -> State = Available
 -> any player may claim it

No reroll occurs on handoff.

If the last carrier position is invalid, use the last valid grounded/safe carrier position. If no valid safe position exists, use the Ice's authored origin as the final fallback.

There is still no intentional **DropIce** action.

Rescue/relay gameplay is allowed: another player may recover a failed carrier's Ice and becomes the depositor if they successfully bring it to their own Pen.

Great Frost + dropped Ice

- Carried Ice survives Great Frost as before.
- If its carrier fails during the already-running Great Frost transition, the dropped Ice survives that transition and becomes shared/available subject to Grab locking.
- A future Great Frost may remove it if it is still unclaimed.
- Great Frost also clears/rebuilds Guarded-Ice threat encounters with the shared field.

Onboarding revision

The former private onboarding-Ice exception is removed.

Onboarding may guide a new player to an accessible shared Regular Ice, but it must not create a private or duplicated wilderness Ice opportunity.

If no suitable Regular Ice is currently available, onboarding may communicate/wait for the shared world refresh rather than violating the shared-Ice rule.

Persistence boundary

Do not persist: - **CurrentWarmth**; - carried Ice ownership; - dropped world-Ice ownership/position; - Frost Sprite health/target/cooldown state; - current breakable damage/state; - universal-tool cooldown; - current Equipped-creature Vitality; - current Ride/Unride state (**IsRiding** / **MountState**); - mount presentation/seat occupancy state; - Frosted/Downed state; - current encounter target.

Persistent creature ownership remains exact **CreatureGUID** copies. Deposited Ice becomes a persistent **ThawItem**; carried/dropped wilderness Ice remains session/world state.

Current validated 11-creature baseline

Creature	Rarity	Ref Kg	Base Visual	Base Income/s	Base Speed
Penguin	Common	25	1.0000	2	22
Rabbit	Common	4	1.0000	2	26
Seal	Common	180	1.0000	3	20
Wolf	Uncommon	65	1.0000	5	31
Bear	Uncommon	500	1.0000	7	26
Mammoth	Rare	6,000	1.4373	15	30
Sleipnir	Rare	900	1.4798	10	39

Creature	Rarity	Ref Kg	Base Visual	Base Income/s	Base Speed
Troll	Epic	1,200	1.4798	24	35
IceSerpent	Epic	3,000	2.2605	20	44
Hraesvlgr	Legendary	5,000	1.7404	32	50
Nidhogg	Legendary	8,000	2.1523	40	46

The 16-species launch quantity target may still be pursued, but the remaining five species/content assignments require explicit later approval rather than resurrecting stale placeholder mappings.

Current functional Ice pools - 11-creature baseline

Rarity weights are ordered Common / Uncommon / Rare / Epic / Legendary.

Ice	Weights	Eligible creatures
Regular	74 / 23 / 3 / 0 / 0	C: Penguin, Rabbit, Seal; U: Wolf, Bear; R: Mammoth
Thick	30 / 35 / 25 / 10 / 0	C: Seal; U: Wolf, Bear; R: Mammoth, Sleipnir; E: Troll
Ancient	0 / 30 / 45 / 25 / 0	U: Bear; R: Mammoth, Sleipnir; E: Troll, IceSerpent
Black	0 / 10 / 35 / 40 / 15	U: Wolf; R: Mammoth, Sleipnir; E: Troll, IceSerpent; L: Hraesvlgr
Meteor	0 / 0 / 20 / 55 / 25	R: Mammoth, Sleipnir; E: Troll, IceSerpent; L: Hraesvlgr, Nidhogg

Unlock ladder: - Regular: core baseline; - Thick: adds Sleipnir + Troll; - Ancient: adds IceSerpent; - Black: adds Hraesvlgr / first Legendary; - Meteor: adds Nidhogg.

Current progression constants retained

Region	Main Ice	Recommended Warmth	Cold Multiplier
Snowfield	Regular	100	1x
Frozen Pass	Thick	1,000	10x
Ancient Expanse	Ancient	10,000	100x
Black Ice Hollow	Black	100,000	1,000x
Meteor Reach	Meteor	1,000,000	10,000x

Core Warmth values: - Starting MaxWarmth: 100; - Base wilderness drain: 4/sec; - Carry multiplier: 2.00x; - Hearth refill: 50% of MaxWarmth/sec; - Low warning: 35%; - Critical warning: 15%.

Documentation versions in this baseline

- 00_Thaw_A_Creature_v1.1_Revision_Summary.md
- 01_Thaw_A_Creature_Concise_GDD_Canonical_v0.7.md
- 02_Thaw_A_Creature_Technical_Implementation_3Week_v0.7.md
- 03_Thaw_A_Creature_Bare_Minimum_Prototype_Technical_v1.0_FINAL.md
- 04_Thaw_A_Creature_Development_Plan_Canonical_v1.1.md
- 05_Thaw_A_Creature_Implementation_Constants_Canonical_v1.1.md
- Thaw_A_Creature_Development_Handoff_v1.1.md

v1.1 production note

The Week-1 Prototype Technical Specification remains **v1.0 FINAL** and is intentionally not rewritten to pretend mounts were validated in Week 1. Mounting is a post-prototype launch-production decision governed by the v0.7/v1.1 production documents.